

Long-term Efficacy of Levodopa/Benserazide (Madopar) in Parkinson's Disease

Neurology Therapeutics Research Group

BACKGROUND: Levodopa combined with a peripheral decarboxylase inhibitor (benserazide) remains the gold standard for symptomatic treatment of Parkinson's disease.

PHARMACOLOGY: Benserazide prevents the peripheral breakdown of levodopa, allowing a greater proportion to cross the blood-brain barrier, thereby reducing peripheral side effects like nausea.

CLINICAL IMPACT: Madopar provides rapid and significant relief of bradykinesia and rigidity, though long-term use requires careful dose titration to manage emerging motor fluctuations and dyskinesias.